

# M/J Visual Art 1 — Teacher Manual

Florida course 0101100 · Grade 6 · Full year · 19 two-week studio modules · Facilitator guide, 2026–2027

**Facilitator copy — do not publish to students.** This manual contains grading guidance, rubric logic, standards codes, and pointers to the quiz answer keys. Nothing in it belongs in the student-facing course. The per-module answer keys live in each module's *TEACHER\_Cycle\_Plan* page, which is likewise never published.

## 0 · HOW TO USE THIS MANUAL

This manual documents the course as actually built: 19 modules, each a fixed two-week studio cycle, in the *04\_Final* build. Read Section 1 before your first week; keep Sections 6–8 (grading) open while you grade; clone Section 10's announcement template every Monday. If you teach a live section that meets four days per week, Section 2 is your planning page. Anything the build could not confirm is marked **[VERIFY]**.

- |   |                                                       |    |                                                         |
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## 1 · HOW THIS COURSE WORKS

### A typical lesson (the Week 1 content page)

Open any module's L01 page (for example, Module 1, *The Seven Elements of Art*) and you will see the same anatomy: the Optima navy header, a metadata strip, then the module's **anchor artwork** — a real, public-domain masterwork embedded directly in the page — described closely before anything is asked of the student. Teaching sections follow (name what you see, place the work in its culture and time), a walkthrough models the four-step critique (describe, analyze, interpret, judge), a **vocabulary box** collects the bolded terms, one short **self-check widget** lets the student test themselves after the teaching, and one factual **AI-awareness callout** (red box) appears where relevant. The page ends by previewing the sketch, VR session, quiz, and artwork. These pages are interactive HTML hosted via GitHub and embedded in Canvas; they are ungraded.

### A typical two-week cycle

| WHEN   | COMPONENT                      | WHAT THE STUDENT DOES                                                                                                                           | GRADED?               | TIER / POINTS       |
|--------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|---------------------|
| Week 1 | L01 Content page               | Studies the anchor artwork and the module's concept; does the self-check                                                                        | No                    | Ungraded            |
| Week 1 | L02 Sketch assignment          | 20–40 min practice sketch on the module's key move; photo upload                                                                                | Completion            | Tier 1 · 10         |
| Week 1 | L03 VR session                 | Gallery walk with the 4-step critique, a talk-about-it prompt (live or solo), and a short draw/build activity; screenshot upload                | Completion            | Tier 1 · 10         |
| Week 1 | L04 Quiz                       | 8 auto-gradable questions (MC, T/F, matching)                                                                                                   | Auto                  | Tier 1 · 10         |
| Week 2 | L05 Artwork + Artist Statement | Makes, signs, and photographs a finished artwork; writes a 1–2 sentence statement in the submission box; saves a copy to the OneDrive portfolio | <b>Teacher-graded</b> | <b>Tier 3 · 100</b> |

One teacher-graded event per cycle. Everything else scores itself. The artist statement is part of the artwork submission and the rubric, not a second grading pass.

### Major assessments

Every module's L05 artwork (100 pts) is the module assessment, graded on the same five-row rubric all year (Section 7). The one structural exception is **Module 19, The World Art Museum** — a curation capstone, not a new artwork. Students select, arrange, and label the year's portfolio (in VR or as a

slideshow) and write a Curator's Statement. Its Tier 1 items are heavier (planning 15, VR gallery 15, quiz 10) and the cycle plan recommends allowing three or more weeks. Course totals: 18 regular modules × 130 pts + capstone 140 pts = **2,480 points**.

**Portfolio dependency.** The capstone assumes students saved each artwork to OneDrive as *VisualArt1\_M#\_Artwork\_YourName*. Reinforce the portfolio-save step in your announcements all year; accept photos of physical originals from students missing files.

## 2 · TEACHING IT LIVE: THE 4-DAY WEEK

The course is written asynchronous-first, and every activity already includes a live format (the VR sessions have live discussion variants built in). A live section that meets **four days per week** maps one module onto eight meetings without changing any Canvas item. The suggested rhythm:

### Week 1 — Learn & Look

| DAY   | MEETING FOCUS (30–45 MIN)                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | ASYNC ITEM IT CARRIES |
|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| Day 1 | Anchor-artwork reveal. Project the L01 page and walk the artwork together before any vocabulary: what do you notice, what is strange or wonderful here? Then read the teaching sections aloud together, pausing at the bolded terms.            | L01 content page      |
| Day 2 | Guided sketch studio. Demonstrate the sketch task's key move yourself (2–3 min, imperfect on purpose), then students sketch while you circulate. Photos uploaded before leaving.                                                                | L02 sketch            |
| Day 3 | VR gallery walk as a class. Run Parts 1–3 of the L03 plan live: gallery manners first, the two-artwork critique in pairs, then the talk-about-it question as a structured turn-taking discussion (the "live class" format printed on the page). | L03 VR session        |
| Day 4 | Vocabulary review game (5 min), then the quiz taken in class. Close by previewing the Week 2 artwork and its "What makes a strong artwork" checklist so students arrive Monday ready to make.                                                   | L04 quiz              |

### Week 2 — Make & Reflect

| DAY   | MEETING FOCUS (30–45 MIN)                                                                                                                                                                           | ASYNC ITEM IT CARRIES          |
|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Day 1 | Artwork launch. Walk the L05 step-by-step together; demonstrate steps 1–2; students begin their outline/plan in class.                                                                              | L05 artwork + artist statement |
| Day 2 | Studio work day. Students work; you circulate with rubric language ("your outlining is strong — where is your value section?"). Name one good move you saw, publicly, at the end.                   |                                |
| Day 3 | Studio finish + statement drafting. Last 10 minutes: students draft the 1–2 sentence artist statement aloud to a partner before typing it.                                                          |                                |
| Day 4 | Mini gallery walk. Finished works held up or posted; each student says one sentence about a classmate's work using an Element term. Sign, photograph, submit, save to the portfolio before leaving. |                                |

**Pacing notes.** A holiday-shortened week drops Day 2 of either week (the studio absorbs it). For Module 19, stretch the same structure across 3+ weeks: Week 1 = becoming-a-curator lesson + planning, Week 2 = hanging the gallery (VR or slideshow) + labels, final week = Curator's Statements and a class exhibition tour. In every module, the live section submits the same Canvas items as On-Demand students; class time simply does the work together.

### One live move per module

| MODULE | TOPIC                         | THE ONE LIVE MOVE WORTH PLANNING                                                                                                              |
|--------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| M1     | Elements of Art               | Seven-corner game: call an element, students point to where the Café Terrace shows it.                                                        |
| M2     | Edo Japan · Great Wave        | Trace the wave's line in the air together; whose arm found the claw shape?                                                                    |
| M3     | Edo Japan · Cherry Blossoms   | Timed 3-minute blossom studies; compare how few marks can say "petal."                                                                        |
| M4     | Prehistoric Cave Art          | Dim the lights and view the cave images "by torchlight" before discussing them.                                                               |
| M5     | Egypt · Sacred Cats           | Profile-pose drawing warm-up: why did Egyptian artists choose the clearest view of each part?                                                 |
| M6     | Egypt · Cartouche             | Decode a cartouche together on the board before students design their own.                                                                    |
| M7     | Greece · Vase Painting        | Pass around any cup or vase: where would the band of figures go? Discuss art jobs then and now.                                               |
| M8     | Rome · One-Point Perspective  | Whole-class demo at the board: one vanishing point, everyone adds a building edge.                                                            |
| M9     | African Masks                 | Symmetry check: partners hold sketches to a mirror or fold them to test balance.                                                              |
| M10    | African Silhouette Landscapes | Value-sort: students order scrap papers light-to-dark to build the sunset gradient idea.                                                      |
| M11    | India · Mandala               | Radial drawing relay: rotate the paper 90° every minute; discuss what symmetry demanded of each artist.                                       |
| M12    | India · Taj Mahal             | Find the symmetry line: students hold a pencil up to the projected façade.                                                                    |
| M13    | China · Pagoda                | Count the eaves together; discuss why each story shrinks (proportion made visible).                                                           |
| M14    | China · Blue Willow           | Tell the willow legend aloud while students find each story element on the plate design.                                                      |
| M15    | Aboriginal Dot Painting       | Patience demonstration: one minute of dots, then discuss why the medium rewards steadiness. Pair with the cultural-respect note (Section 14). |
| M16    | Native American Totem Poles   | Stacked-symbol brainstorm: which three symbols would stand for your family? (Personal symbols, not clan crests — see Section 14.)             |
| M17    | Maya Glyphs                   | Glyph-decoding warm-up in pairs before students compose their own name glyph block.                                                           |
| M18    | Aztec Sun Stone               | Concentric-circle floor diagram: students physically stand in the rings to learn the stone's zones.                                           |
| M19    | World Art Museum capstone     | Run the final week as a real exhibition opening: students tour each other's museums as visitors, guestbook comments included.                 |

### 3 · UNGRADED INTERACTIVES (AND WHY THERE ARE NO WRAPPERS)

**Self-check widgets.** Each L01 content page carries one interactive self-check placed after the teaching. It gives the student immediate feedback and costs you nothing: no submission, no grade, nothing to chase. A student who skips it shows up indirectly, in quiz and artwork performance, not as a missing grade. Treat it as practice, not compliance.

**This course has no module intro/outro wrapper quizzes.** Other Optima courses bracket each module with survey-mode Canvas quizzes that harvest confidence ratings and "what's still unclear" data; this build intentionally keeps the module to its five student items and routes reflection into the artist statement instead. Your equivalent triage move: after grading each module's artworks, **read the artist statements as a set** (10–15 minutes). Statements that are vague, or that name the same struggle repeatedly ("I couldn't get the shading"), are your early-warning data. Answer them with a targeted announcement or a quick check-in message.

### 4 · AI & VR IN THIS COURSE (STUDENT-FACING)

**AI.** The course's posture is awareness, not required use. Each L01 page includes one short, factual AI callout (the red box) stating what AI can and cannot do for that module's kind of work; no specific tool is named and no assignment requires AI. The syllabus policy is the school-wide one: AI may support learning, may never do the student's making or writing, and its use should be briefly disclosed. Do not add new AI requirements; if a student's artist statement reads machine-written, handle it through Section 9's conversation-first approach.

**VR.** Every module's L03 is a platform-agnostic gallery session: exhibition manners, a two-artwork critique in the describe–analyze–interpret–judge order, a discussion prompt with printed live and solo formats, and a short make-something activity (draw or build). Students may choose any gallery Location available to them. Completion evidence is one screenshot or photo, friction kept near zero. Every session works without VR: the equivalent no-headset path (viewing the works on screen and doing the same tasks) earns the same credit. **[VERIFY]** Add platform-specific navigation names to your own notes once Optima's new VR platform is announced; do not edit them into the course pages.

## 5 · USING IGNITE AI TO SUPPORT STUDENTS (TEACHER-FACING)

**[VERIFY] before relying on specifics:** Ignite AI's feature set varies by Canvas release and by what Optima has enabled. Confirm against Optima's Canvas instance; the uses below are functional, not button-by-button.

With roughly 500 students, the Canvas AI assistant is how grading stays personal. The standing rule for every use: **AI drafts, the teacher decides**. You read, edit, and own anything sent to a student or family. Never use it to surveil, rank, or auto-penalize.

- **Draft individualized artwork feedback.** Paste your rubric scores and one observation; let it draft the comment; edit until it sounds like you. Aim: every student gets one specific sentence about *their* piece.
- **Summarize the module's artist statements** to surface the cohort's common struggle before you write the next announcement.
- **Surface students who need a nudge** (missing sketches, declining quiz scores, no portfolio saves) and draft a warm check-in you then personalize.
- **Generate practice variants** for a student who needs another rep, e.g. a second value-scale exercise before re-attempting a sketch.
- **Draft family communications**, including translations, for the cultural-content advance notices in Section 14.

## 6 · GRADING CATEGORIES & CANVAS GRADEBOOK SETUP

The course is **points-based as built** (2,480 total). Create three assignment groups; weighting is optional because the point structure already carries the intended emphasis (~76 / 16 / 8).

| ASSIGNMENT GROUP                                       | CONTAINS                                                                            | POINTS | GRADING METHOD                                         |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Artworks &amp; Artist Statements</b><br>(Tier 3)    | Each module's L05 artwork; M19 curation capstone                                    | 1,900  | Rubric in SpeedGrader (Section 7)                      |
| <b>Studio Practice — Sketches &amp; VR</b><br>(Tier 1) | 18 sketches (10 ea) + 18 VR sessions (10 ea) + M19 planning (15) + M19 gallery (15) | 390    | Completion (submitted + sincere attempt = full credit) |
| <b>Module Quizzes</b> (Tier 1)                         | 19 quizzes, 8 questions each                                                        | 190    | Auto-graded by Canvas                                  |

**Setup steps:** (1) Assignments → +Group, create the three groups above. (2) Build each module's five items inside its module, assigning the group as you go; paste the RCE-safe HTML from the build files into assignments, and create quizzes as Canvas Quizzes with answers marked from the module's cycle-plan key. (3) Settings → Grading Scheme: apply the school's letter scheme **[VERIFY]**. (4) Set the late policy to match the syllabus: no per-item late penalty, 10% deduction in a quarter's final 14 days, zero after quarter close **[VERIFY against current school policy]**. (5) For completion items, grade on submission: full points for a sincere attempt, and use the comment box rather than partial points when an attempt is thin. (6) Use the module requirements/progress view as your at-a-glance signal for who is moving.

## 7 · RUBRICS

One rubric, all year, every regular module's artwork — identical rows so grading stays near five minutes per student. Paste it into each L05 assignment as a native Canvas Rubric so it scores in SpeedGrader. The five criteria (each scored Excellent 4 / Proficient 3 / Developing 2 / Beginning 1, scaled to 100 pts):

| CRITERION                            | WHAT EXCELLENT LOOKS LIKE                                          | WHAT BEGINNING LOOKS LIKE  |
|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| <b>Elements &amp; Principles</b>     | The module's target elements clearly, correctly, deliberately used | Few elements attempted     |
| <b>Craftsmanship &amp; Technique</b> | Neat, bold outlines; full, careful color; evident care             | Little care or effort      |
| <b>Creative Problem-Solving</b>      | Original choices throughout, personal voice                        | Minimal engagement         |
| <b>Artist Statement</b>              | Specific, personal, uses art vocabulary                            | Minimal or missing         |
| <b>Completion &amp; Signature</b>    | Complete, all requirements met, signed by the artist               | Incomplete and/or unsigned |

The signature row is the responsibility-and-honesty row: signing the work is part of the grade in every module. **Module 19** uses the capstone variant printed on its L05 page (selection & theme, labels, arrangement, Curator's Statement, completion); same five-row shape, curation language. **There are no free-response quiz questions anywhere in the course** — all 152 quiz questions are auto-gradable — so no quiz answer guides are needed beyond the keys already in the cycle plans.

## 8 · QUIZZES & ACTIVITIES: HOW TO RUN AND GRADE EACH TYPE

| TYPE (19 OF EACH UNLESS NOTED)      | WHAT IT IS                                                                                                                                            | YOUR MOVE                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Auto-graded quiz</b>             | 8 questions: MC, T/F, matching. Type alternates between Elements/Principles quizzes and art-history quizzes module to module; M19's is a year-review. | Build as a Canvas Quiz with answers marked from the module's <i>TEACHER_Cycle_Plan</i> key. Never publish the key. Skim the item analysis after each module; re-teach the most-missed question in your announcement. |
| <b>Sketch assignment</b>            | Low-stakes practice on the module's key move; photo upload.                                                                                           | Completion credit for a sincere attempt. Do not rubric-grade it; drop one encouraging comment on 5–10 per module, rotating who gets them.                                                                            |
| <b>VR session</b>                   | Gallery walk + critique + create; screenshot upload.                                                                                                  | Completion credit; the no-VR path earns the same. Watch for students who never enter VR and check whether it is an access problem.                                                                                   |
| <b>Artwork + statement</b> (Tier 3) | The module's one graded assessment.                                                                                                                   | Rubric pass in SpeedGrader, ~5 min each; read statements as a set afterward (Section 3).                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Self-check widget</b>            | On each L01 page.                                                                                                                                     | Nothing. It grades itself invisibly and produces no submission.                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Capstone (M19 only)</b>          | Planning doc, gallery hang, curation + Curator's Statement.                                                                                           | Completion for planning and gallery; rubric for the curation. Budget double time (Section 11).                                                                                                                       |

There are **no discussion forums** in this course; the conversational work lives in the VR talk-about-it prompts and, in live sections, in class.

## 9 · COACH, NOT CATCH

- Feedback names the next step, not just the flaw, and leads with what is working: "Your wave's curve is confident — next time let the foam break the outline."
- Allow re-attempts on sketches and quizzes where policy permits; Tier 1 is practice, not a trap.
- Use analytics and Ignite AI to find students who need help *early*, then reach out warmly. Never to build a case.
- Suspected AI-written statements or traced/copied artwork: open a conversation first. Ask the student to tell you about their piece; a student who made the work can always talk about it. Treat the conversation as formation, not prosecution.
- Public praise names good thinking specifically; weak work is coached privately.

## 10 · WEEKLY ANNOUNCEMENT SCRIPTS

Asynchronous students hear you mainly through the Monday announcement. Clone this template every week; the table below gives each module's focus and the one thing not to miss.

### TEMPLATE — CLONE FOR ANY WEEK

"Happy Monday, artists! This week we are in **[Module N: topic]** — [one sentence of genuine enthusiasm about the anchor artwork or task]. By Friday you should have [items due this week]. The one thing not to miss: **[key deadline or step]**. [One-line encouragement.] — [Your name]"

### SITUATIONAL — PRE-ARTWORK WEEK

"This is a making week. Before you start, read the 'What makes a strong artwork' box on the assignment — it is exactly what I grade with. Photograph in good light, sign your work, and save a copy to your portfolio folder (*VisualArt1\_M#\_Artwork\_YourName*). Future-you needs it for the museum capstone in May."

### SITUATIONAL — RE-ENGAGEMENT NUDGE (INDIVIDUAL MESSAGE)

"Hi [name] — I noticed I have not seen work from you since [module]. No lecture, just a hand: what is in the way? If it is time, start with the sketch (20 minutes). If it is the material, come to office hours [time] and we will do it together."

### SITUATIONAL — QUARTER CLOSE (SEND 3 WEEKS OUT)

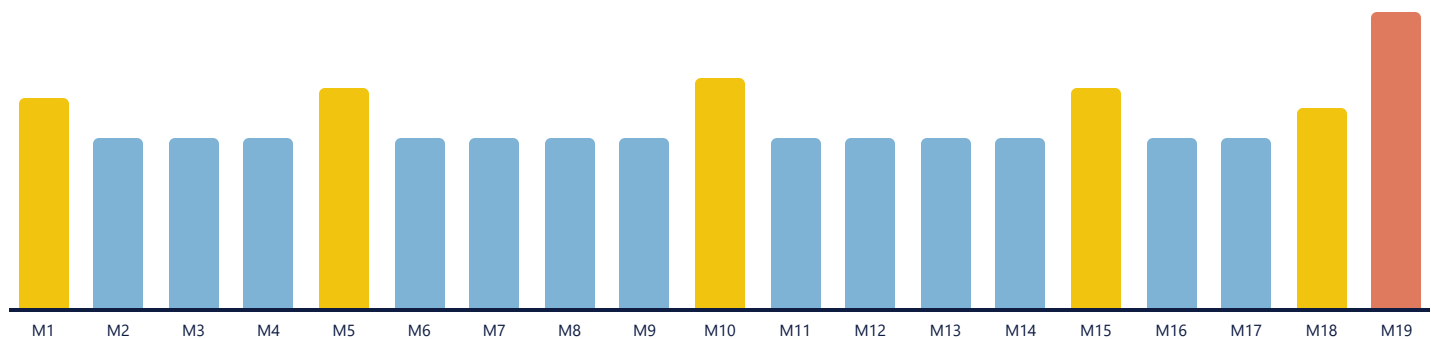
"Quarter [N] closes on [date]. Anything unsubmitted at close becomes a zero, and work in the last 14 days takes a 10% deduction — so this week is the cheapest week to catch up. Your checklist is the module list: sketch, VR, quiz, artwork for Modules [range]."

### Per-module focus lines

| MODULE | WEEK FOCUS FOR YOUR ANNOUNCEMENT                                                                                            | DON'T MISS                                                                  |
|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| M1     | The seven Elements are the artist's whole toolkit; Van Gogh's café uses every one.                                          | Set up the OneDrive portfolio folder now — it is used all year.             |
| M2     | Hokusai's Great Wave: one line can carry a whole picture.                                                                   | The sketch feeds directly into the artwork; do it first.                    |
| M3     | Cherry blossoms: how little it takes to say "spring."                                                                       | Quiz type changed this module — review the vocabulary box.                  |
| M4     | The first artists worked by firelight; look at what they could do.                                                          | Earth-tone palette: gather your browns/reds before the artwork day.         |
| M5     | Egyptian cats: why every part is shown from its clearest angle.                                                             | Profile view is the skill; practice it in the sketch.                       |
| M6     | Your name, written the way pharaohs wrote theirs.                                                                           | Plan the cartouche symbols before inking.                                   |
| M7     | Greek vases: pictures that survived 2,500 years on pottery.                                                                 | Q1 closes soon — check the module checklist.                                |
| M8     | One vanishing point changes everything you draw from now on.                                                                | Use a ruler; perspective rewards precision.                                 |
| M9     | African masks: balance and boldness you can feel.                                                                           | Symmetry check before coloring.                                             |
| M10    | A sunset, a silhouette, and the power of value.                                                                             | Semester 1 closes with this module; portfolio check.                        |
| M11    | Mandalas: pattern, patience, and radial symmetry.                                                                           | Work from the center out.                                                   |
| M12    | The Taj Mahal: architecture as perfect balance.                                                                             | Light pencil first; symmetry is unforgiving.                                |
| M13    | Pagodas: proportion stacked toward the sky.                                                                                 | Count your eave levels before outlining.                                    |
| M14    | Blue Willow: a whole story on a single plate.                                                                               | Blue only — value does the work of color this module.                       |
| M15    | Dot painting: steadiness as a style. Respect note: we learn from the technique; sacred stories belong to their communities. | Q3 closes soon — check the module checklist.                                |
| M16    | Totem poles: symbols stacked into a family story — yours, this time.                                                        | Choose your three symbols before drawing.                                   |
| M17    | Maya glyphs: writing you can draw.                                                                                          | Glyph blocks read in pairs; plan the layout.                                |
| M18    | The Sun Stone: a calendar, a cosmos, a masterpiece of radial design.                                                        | Start gathering your year's work — the museum opens next module.            |
| M19    | You are the curator now. Choose, arrange, label, and open your museum.                                                      | The Curator's Statement is graded; the portfolio makes or breaks this week. |

## 11 · TEACHER WORKFLOW & WORKLOAD MAP

**A normal cycle, in order:** Monday of Week 1, post the announcement (10 min). Through Week 1, completion-check sketches and VR screenshots in batches (15–20 min total) and glance at the quiz item analysis (5 min). Week 2's back half is the real work: rubric-grade the artworks in SpeedGrader (~5 min/student), then read the artist statements as a set and answer patterns in the next announcement. Messages and office hours run underneath. Tier 1 costs you nearly nothing; the Tier 3 pass is the block to protect on your calendar.



Relative facilitator load per module, from the tiered item counts. Blue = the steady cycle (one rubric pass). Gold = quarter-close catch-up grading (M5, M10, M15) plus the M1 launch and M18 capstone prep. Coral = M19: the multi-week curation capstone, portfolio troubleshooting, and year-end close land together — protect extra calendar time here.

## 12 · STANDARDS COVERAGE MAP — FLORIDA NGSSS (0101100)

The official course standards for M/J Visual Art 1 (CPALMS course #0101100, version 2025-and-beyond) are the fifteen VA.68 benchmarks below, plus course-wide B.E.S.T. expectations. Module tags are read from the build's teacher cycle plans. Codes stay in teacher documents only.

| BENCHMARK          | DESCRIPTION (OFFICIAL)                                                                                          | WHERE TAUGHT (MODULES)                                                                                              | WHERE ASSESSED                       |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| <b>VA.68.C.1.1</b> | Apply a range of interests and contextual connections to influence the art-making and self-reflection processes | All 19                                                                                                              | Every artwork + artist statement     |
| <b>VA.68.C.2.4</b> | Use constructive criticism as a purposeful tool for artistic growth                                             | M11, M12, M17, M18, M19                                                                                             | M19 capstone (primary)               |
| <b>VA.68.F.1.4</b> | Use technology skills to create an imaginative and unique work of art                                           | <b>Not tagged in any module</b> — but practiced in every module's VR draw/build activity                            | — (see gap note)                     |
| <b>VA.68.F.2.5</b> | Create an artist statement to reflect on personal artwork for a portfolio or exhibition                         | <b>Not tagged in any module</b> — but practiced in every module (statement + portfolio save) and the M19 exhibition | — (see gap note)                     |
| <b>VA.68.F.3.4</b> | Follow directions and complete art tasks in a timely manner to show development of 21st-century skills          | M7, M19                                                                                                             | Completion & Signature rubric row    |
| <b>VA.68.H.1.2</b> | Identify suitable audience behavior needed to view or experience artworks                                       | M1–M5, M16–M19 (+ gallery-manners block in every VR session)                                                        | VR sessions; M19 exhibition          |
| <b>VA.68.H.3.1</b> | Discuss how knowledge and skills from art-making and analysis solve problems in non-art contexts                | M6–M9, M11–M19                                                                                                      | Quizzes; artist statements           |
| <b>VA.68.O.1.3</b> | Combine creative and technical knowledge to produce visually strong works of art                                | All 19                                                                                                              | Elements & Principles rubric row     |
| <b>VA.68.O.2.3</b> | Create a work of personal art using various media to solve an open-ended artistic problem                       | M6–M18                                                                                                              | Module artworks                      |
| <b>VA.68.S.1.4</b> | Use accurate art vocabulary to explain the creative and art-making processes                                    | M1–M16, M18                                                                                                         | Artist Statement rubric row; quizzes |
| <b>VA.68.S.2.1</b> | Organize the structural elements of art to achieve artistic goals                                               | M1–M10, M17                                                                                                         | Module artworks                      |
| <b>VA.68.S.2.2</b> | Create artwork requiring sequentially ordered procedures and specified media                                    | M1–M8, M10–M18                                                                                                      | Step-by-step artwork tasks           |
| <b>VA.68.S.2.3</b> | Use visual-thinking and problem-solving skills in a sketchbook or journal                                       | M9–M11, M14–M16                                                                                                     | Sketch assignments                   |
| <b>VA.68.S.3.1</b> | Use 2-D or 3-D art materials and tools to understand their potential and limitations                            | M1–M6, M10, M12–M15                                                                                                 | Craftsmanship rubric row             |
| <b>VA.68.S.3.3</b> | Demonstrate understanding of safety protocols for media, tools, processes, and techniques                       | Tagged (with S.3.1) in M1–M6, M10, M12–M15 — but no student-facing page teaches safety explicitly                   | — (see gap note)                     |

**Gap notes (course-revision flags, reported to Academic Design at build sign-off).** (1) **VA.68.F.1.4** and **VA.68.F.2.5** are required course benchmarks that no cycle plan claims, though the course substantively does both every module (VR create tasks; artist statements + portfolio). Recommended fix: tag F.2.5 in every cycle plan (or at minimum M19) and F.1.4 in the VR-create context. (2) **VA.68.S.3.3** is claimed in eleven cycle plans as "care for materials and workspace," but the benchmark's official language is *safety protocols*, and no student-facing lesson mentions safety. Recommended fix: one short "studio safety and care" block in M1 (scissors, markers, workspace, washing up) satisfies it honestly. Until revised, treat these three as facilitator-supplied: name the safety expectations in your M1 announcement, and read the artist statement as the F.2.5 evidence it already is.

**Course-wide embedded standards:** the course description also attaches Florida's B.E.S.T. ELA Expectations (ELA.K12.EE.1.1–6.1), Mathematical Thinking & Reasoning standards (MA.K12.MTR.1.1–7.1), and ELD.K12.ELL.SI.1, to be embedded as applicable; the artist statements (evidence and voice), step-sequenced studio tasks (patterns, structure, perseverance), and VR discussions (collaborative techniques) are where they naturally live. **Catalog note:** CPALMS lists 0101100 as a *semester* elective; Optima delivers it as a full-year course, which exceeds rather than conflicts with the state minimum — worth knowing if a family asks.

### By module (quick reference)

| MODULE         | BENCHMARKS CARRIED (VA.68.*)                                                       |
|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>M1–M5</b>   | C.1.1 · O.1.3 · S.1.4 · S.2.1 · S.2.2 · S.3.1/S.3.3 · H.1.2 (M4–5 lead with H.1.2) |
| <b>M6</b>      | H.3.1 · O.1.3 · O.2.3 · C.1.1 · S.1.4 · S.2.1 · S.2.2 · S.3.1/S.3.3                |
| <b>M7</b>      | H.3.1 · C.1.1 · O.1.3 · O.2.3 · S.1.4 · S.2.1 · S.2.2 · F.3.4                      |
| <b>M8</b>      | O.1.3 · O.2.3 · C.1.1 · S.1.4 · S.2.1 · S.2.2 · H.3.1                              |
| <b>M9</b>      | H.3.1 · C.1.1 · O.1.3 · O.2.3 · S.1.4 · S.2.1 · S.2.3                              |
| <b>M10</b>     | O.1.3 · O.2.3 · C.1.1 · S.1.4 · S.2.1 · S.2.2 · S.2.3 · S.3.1/S.3.3                |
| <b>M11</b>     | H.3.1 · C.1.1 · C.2.4 · O.1.3 · O.2.3 · S.1.4 · S.2.2 · S.2.3                      |
| <b>M12</b>     | O.1.3 · O.2.3 · C.1.1 · C.2.4 · S.1.4 · S.2.2 · S.3.1/S.3.3 · H.3.1                |
| <b>M13</b>     | H.3.1 · O.1.3 · O.2.3 · C.1.1 · S.1.4 · S.2.2 · S.3.1/S.3.3                        |
| <b>M14–M15</b> | H.3.1 · O.1.3 · O.2.3 · C.1.1 · S.1.4 · S.2.2 · S.2.3/S.3.1/S.3.3                  |
| <b>M16</b>     | H.1.2 · H.3.1 · O.1.3 · O.2.3 · C.1.1 · S.1.4 · S.2.2 · S.2.3                      |
| <b>M17</b>     | H.1.2 · H.3.1 · C.1.1 · C.2.4 · O.1.3 · O.2.3 · S.2.1 · S.2.2                      |
| <b>M18</b>     | O.1.3 · O.2.3 · C.1.1 · C.2.4 · H.1.2 · H.3.1 · S.1.4 · S.2.2                      |
| <b>M19</b>     | C.2.4 (primary) · C.1.1 · H.1.2 · H.3.1 · O.1.3 · F.3.4                            |

### 13 · WHAT MAKES THIS COURSE CLASSICAL & CULTIVATING CULTURE

**The classical moves, where they actually live:** Wonder before mechanism — every L01 opens on a real masterwork and asks what the student notices before any term is defined. Imitation before invention — each sketch practices a master's move (Hokusai's line, Egyptian profile, radial symmetry) before the artwork asks for the student's own version; that is the atelier ladder, climbed nineteen times. Ordered judgment — the describe–analyze–interpret–judge sequence runs through every lesson walkthrough and VR critique: students earn opinions by looking first. The Great Conversation in images — nineteen modules of world cultures, each work placed in its time and place, dates carried with A.D./B.C. And virtue made visible — craftsmanship is perseverance, the portfolio is responsibility, and the required signature on every artwork is honesty: *this is mine; I made it; I stand behind it*.

**Culture, asynchronously:** name students' good moves specifically and publicly (announcements are your gallery wall); model curiosity in your own voice ("I never noticed the boat in the Wave's trough until this week"); hold the signature and portfolio rituals seriously so students feel their body of work growing; and treat the M19 museum as a real exhibition — invite families to view it. Feedback is a relationship: one specific sentence per student per module beats three generic ones.

### 14 · CULTURAL & SENSITIVE-CONTENT NOTES, WITH FAMILY SCRIPTS

This course contains no mature-content flags in the usual sense. What it does carry is **sacred and ceremonial art from living cultures**, which some families appreciate advance notice about, and which deserves accurate, respectful handling. Where it appears:

| MODULE         | CONTENT                                                                                         | HANDLING NOTE                                                                                                |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>M5–M6</b>   | Ancient Egyptian religion (sacred animals, gods, names as protective symbols)                   | Presented historically and factually.                                                                        |
| <b>M9</b>      | African masks, which are ceremonial and spiritual objects in their source cultures              | Students study design principles and make their own original mask design, not a replica of a sacred object.  |
| <b>M11</b>     | The mandala, a sacred form in Hindu and Buddhist practice                                       | Taught as radial design with its cultural context named accurately.                                          |
| <b>M15</b>     | Aboriginal Australian dot painting; Dreaming stories are sacred and community-owned             | Students learn the technique and tell their own stories; the course does not copy sacred narratives.         |
| <b>M16</b>     | Totem poles; crests and stories belong to specific Northwest Coast families and clans           | Students design personal symbols, not clan crests.                                                           |
| <b>M17–M18</b> | Maya and Aztec religious art; the Sun Stone sits in a religious context that included sacrifice | Lessons center design, symbolism, and calendar knowledge; historical context is factual and age-appropriate. |

**[VERIFY]** Skim each module's L01 page the week before it opens so any specifics you send families match the page's actual wording.

#### ADVANCE-NOTICE SCRIPT — ADAPT PER MODULE

"Hello families — in the coming weeks our art course visits [culture/art form]. Some of these artworks are religious or ceremonial in their home cultures, and we teach that context factually and respectfully; scholars learn the design ideas and make original work of their own rather than copying sacred objects or stories. This is part of the course's year-long journey through world art. Questions are always welcome — [your name and contact]."

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M/J Visual Art 1 (Florida 0101100) · Teacher Manual · Optima Academy Online, 2026–2027 · Synthesized from the 04\_Final course build (19 modules × 6 files, gate-passed) and the CPALMS course description for #0101100 (version 2025-and-beyond, exported 4/13/2026). Facilitator copy: contains grading guidance and standards codes — do not publish to students. Re-render from MJ-Visual-Art-1-TEACHER-MANUAL.html when the course is revised.